

the beginning of Apple's switch to aluminium as its material of choice for its premium products.

While the G5 processor was being used to build supercomputers at Virginia Tech university, a new iMac was released in 2004. By now, it became obvious that each of Apple's products would receive an overhaul in roughly two years. The 'iMac G5' became an all-in-one PC with all the components hidden away behind the screen. It was also the slimmest all-in-one PC measuring about 2 inches in thickness.

A well oiled machine

With all its products selling like hot cakes, Apple had the means and funds to develop a whole bunch of products, and 2004 also witnessed the launch of two new versions of the flagship iPod, later named the 'Classic' and the now discontinued 'iPod Mini'. It experimented with materials and added more features.

This continued well into the next year as the iPod Classic came out with video capabilities as opposed to just music and photos in its previous generation. The year 2005 was the year of the iPod as it introduced the first generation 'iPod Nano', a replacement to the second generation Mini. Apple also released the first "affordable" iPod, the 'iPod Shuffle' which was finished in plastic, didn't have the trademark click wheel or a display of any sort.

It was the same year that Apple Store operations were no longer restricted to the US and more stores opened up in the UK, Japan and Canada.

After fighting Intel tooth and nail, Apple shocked the world in 2006. Rumours had been doing the rounds that secret versions of OS X were being made for Intel processors as well as the regular PowerPC processors. Jobs confirmed these rumours and announced to the world that Apple would be switching over to Intel's processors. He also announced that all Apple devices running OS X would transition to Intel processors by the end of 2006.

This switch proved advantageous as the PowerPC chips weren't as good as the ones made by Intel, and for the first time in history a Mac could run Windows. By now, OS X was in its fifth iteration and the sixth was announced. Each upgrade brought with it more features and the operating system only got better.

This was also the case with newer products being rolled out featuring Intel's chips. The 'MacBook Pro', a replacement to the PowerBook G4, looked more or less the same, however, looks were the only thing the two had in common.